

ROUND SUMMARY -- ALL TIPS AT A GLANCE

MATCH	VENUE	DATE	TIP	PROB	MARGIN	
Hawthorn vs Adelaide	York Park	2026-05-21	Hawthorn	63%	~12pts	M
Richmond vs Essendon	MCG	2026-05-22	Richmond	52%	~3pts	M
Fremantle vs St Kilda	Perth Stadium	2026-05-22	Fremantle	72%	~23pts	M
North Melbourne vs Gold Co	Docklands	2026-05-23	Gold Coast	63%	~12pts	M
Geelong vs Sydney	Kardinia Park	2026-05-23	Geelong	72%	~28pts	M
Collingwood vs West Coast	MCG	2026-05-23	Collingwood	77%	~41pts	M
Port Adelaide vs Carlton	Adelaide Oval	2026-05-23	Carlton	54%	~5pts	M
GWS Giants vs Brisbane Lio	Sydney Showgro	2026-05-24	Brisbane Lions	62%	~8pts	M
Western Bulldogs vs Melbou	Docklands	2026-05-24	Western Bulldogs	61%	~8pts	M

DETAILED MATCH ANALYSIS

Round 11 | York Park | 2026-05-21

Hawthorn vs Adelaide

MEDIUM CONFIDENCE

TIP: Hawthorn 63% win probability approx. 12pt margin

Hawthorn \$1.54 (64.8% implied) | Adelaide \$2.48 (40.3% implied) | Line: Hawthorn Hawks giving 10.1 pts

PREDICTED WINNER: Hawthorn

WIN PROBABILITY: Hawthorn: 63% | Adelaide: 37%

Derivation: Weighted 40% Squiggle model (59.1% Hawthorn), 35% betting market adjusted for overround (64.8% -> 62%), and 25% recent form and venue data. Squiggle and market closely aligned; form data (Adelaide's recent streak vs Hawthorn's home dominance) provided minor adjustment upward for Hawthorn.

PREDICTED MARGIN: ~12 points

The line market predicts 10.1 pts; Squiggle predicts 14.3 pts. Hawthorn's last-5 average margin at York Park is +37.4 pts (5W-0L), though Adelaide's recent defensive tightening (last 3: -67.0 pts allowed, +35.3 pts average margin) and offensive improvement (last 3: 102.3 pts) moderates extreme extrapolation. Anchor at 12 pts as a compromise between venue dominance and Adelaide's current trajectory.

KEY FACTORS:

- Hawthorn's York Park fortress (5W-0L last 5, 76% all-time win rate, +22.2 avg margin historically). This is Hawthorn's strongest venue in the dataset. Adelaide's York Park record is 25% (2W-6L, -15.0 avg margin over 8 games). The 51-point win-rate gap at this ground is the single largest structural advantage in the dataset.
- Adelaide's recent form momentum (4W-1L last 5, +11.0 avg margin, +35.3 pts last 3). Adelaide has won 4 of its last 5 with consistent attacking output (97.0 pts/5 games, 102.3 pts/3 games). This directly contradicts their ladder position (8th) and suggests genuine improvement that the market may not fully reflect.
- Hawthorn's defensive deterioration (90.0 pts allowed last 5, 100.3 pts allowed last 3, trend: "leaking more"). Hawthorn conceded 120 pts to Melbourne and 88 pts to Fremantle in its last two games. Adelaide's current attack (102.3 pts/3) will exploit this vulnerability more effectively than Adelaide's typical output.
- Both teams on 5-day rest (short turnaround). Equal fatigue exposure; no differentiator. However, neither team has a clear travel advantage due to missing venue mapping data (York Park location unknown in dataset).

SCORING TRENDS ANALYSIS:

- Hawthorn (last 5 | last 3):
- For: 89.6 pts | 82.3 pts (attack trend: stable, but declining in absolute terms)
 - Against: 90.0 pts | 100.3 pts (defence trend: leaking more ^)
 - Average margin: -0.4 pts | -18.0 pts (last 3 significantly negative)

- Adelaide (last 5 | last 3):
- For: 97.0 pts | 102.3 pts (attack trend: stable, improving in absolute terms)
 - Against: 86.0 pts | 67.0 pts (defence trend: tightening v)
 - Average margin: +11.0 pts | +35.3 pts (last 3 significantly positive)

Scoring advantage: Adelaide. Adelaide is outscoring opponents by an average of 35.3 pts in its last 3 games, while Hawthorn is being outscored by 18.0 pts. Adelaide's defence has conceded 19 fewer points per game in its last 3 vs last 5. However, this is offset by Hawthorn's venue mastery and Adelaide's historically poor performance at York Park.

HOME GROUND ADVANTAGE:

- Hawthorn (season): Home 5W-5L (100%); Away 2W-5L (40%) -- 60-point win-rate gap (significant home advantage).
- Adelaide (season): Home 4W-6L (67%); Away 2W-4L (50%) -- 17-point win-rate gap.

- At York Park specifically:
- Hawthorn: 5W-0L (last 5 games) | 66W-21L all-time (76% win rate, avg +22.2 pts)
 - Adelaide: 1W-1L (last 2 games) | 2W-6L all-time (25% win rate, avg -15.0 pts)

Estimated home ground advantage value: York Park is a traditional Hawthorn fortress with 87 historical games recorded. The 51-point difference in win rates between the two teams at this venue, combined with the 37.2-point average margin differential, suggests York Park carries approximately 15-18 points of advantage for Hawthorn above a neutral venue. This is consistent with AFL fortress venues (typically 8-15 pts, but York Park appears to be a stronger fortress for Hawthorn than average).

MARKET & MODEL ANALYSIS:

- Head-to-head market (implied): Hawthorn \$1.54 = 64.8% implied probability. Adelaide \$2.48 = 40.3% implied probability. (Note: these sum to 105.1%, indicating ~5% overround; true market probabilities are approximately Hawthorn 61.7% | Adelaide 38.3% before overround.)
- Line market (implied): Hawthorn giving 10.1 pts. This implies a ~10-point Hawthorn win as the equilibrium prediction.
- Squiggle model: Hawthorn 59.1% win probability, 14.3-point expected margin.

Consensus: All three data sources favour Hawthorn (market: 61.7%, Squiggle: 59.1%, line: +10.1 pts). Market and Squiggle agree within 2.6 percentage points. Line market's 10.1 pts sits between my predicted 12 pts and Squiggle's 14.3 pts, suggesting consistency.

Weighting: I weighted Squiggle 40% and market 35% because both are independent statistical inputs with no emotional bias. I gave form/venue data 25% weight because it directly contradicts the slight bullishness in the line market -- Adelaide's recent form (4W-1L, +35.3 pts margin last 3) is strong enough to narrow Hawthorn's expected margin vs what the market prices at a neutral ground.

FATIGUE & TRAVEL IMPACT:

- Hawthorn: 5 days rest (short turnaround, mild fatigue risk).
- Adelaide: 5 days rest (short turnaround, mild fatigue risk).

Travel: York Park location cannot be mapped from the dataset (listed as Hawthorn's "home" but Hawthorn's registered home is Melbourne). If York Park is not Melbourne, Hawthorn has travel. If York Park is not Adelaide, Adelaide has travel. Data is insufficient.

Impact assessment: Equal rest days negate fatigue as a differentiator. Without venue mapping, I cannot quantify travel load. Fatigue is not a material factor in this match -- both teams are equally affected. This slightly favours Hawthorn because fatigue would have been Adelaide's only plausible advantage against home-ground disadvantage.

WEATHER IMPACT:

Forecast: Data unavailable for York Park.

Impact: Unable to assess. Generic AFL principle: wet, windy conditions typically reduce scoring and favour ground-based disposal; dry, still conditions favour high-possession teams with strong kicking. Neither team's scoring profile (Hawthorn 89.6 pts avg, Adelaide 97.0 pts avg) suggests a preference for either extreme. Neutral assumption applied.

TEAM NEWS IMPACT:

Hawthorn:

- Will Day (midfielder): Returning from absence -- positive, adds midfield depth.
- Jack Gunston (forward): 50-50 due to mild foot sprain, short turnaround -- likely OUT. Loss of key forward depth.
- No other confirmed ins/outs.

Adelaide:

- Mabior Chol (forward): Expected to return from hamstring injury -- **positive, bol

Round 11 | MCG | 2026-05-22

Richmond vs Essendon

MEDIUM CONFIDENCE

TIP: Richmond

52% win probability approx. 3pt margin

Richmond \$2.67 (37.4% implied) | Essendon \$1.48 (67.6% implied) | Line: Essendon Bombers giving 13.1 pts

MATCH PREDICTION: Richmond vs Essendon | Round 11 | MCG | 2026-05-22

PREDICTED WINNER: Richmond

WIN PROBABILITY: Richmond: 52% | Essendon: 48%

Derived from: Squiggle model (50.0% Richmond, neutral) weighted at 40%; betting market (37.4% Richmond implied, adjusted for overround, weighted at 30%); form data (Richmond 1W-5L vs Essendon 0W-5L, weighted at 20%); home ground advantage (historical MCG data, weighted at 10%). The Squiggle model's 50.0% equilibrium and Richmond's superior recent form (1 win vs 0 wins) offset the betting market's strong Essendon preference (\$1.48 vs \$2.67).

PREDICTED MARGIN: ~3 points (Richmond by)

The line market prices Essendon at 13.1 points favourites. However, this contradicts the Squiggle model's 0.1 point margin prediction and ignores recent form data. Richmond's last-5 average margin is -38.2 pts, but last-3 is -20.6 pts (improvement trajectory). Essendon's last-5 is -41.4 pts with no improvement (last-3: -40.4 pts). Adjusting the line market downward by ~10 points to account for this form reversal and the model's near-equilibrium prediction yields a narrow Richmond margin.

KEY FACTORS:

- Form reversal over last 3 games: Richmond's defensive trend is "tightening" with last-3 average concession of 98.3 pts vs last-5 average of 110.2 pts (11.9 pts improvement). Essendon's last-3 defence shows no tightening (116.7 pts vs 121.2 pts last-5; only 4.5 pts improvement). This represents a meaningful 12.4-point defensive advantage shift to Richmond over the relevant timeframe.
- Venue-specific weakness for both teams this season: Richmond 0W-5L at MCG this season (avg margin 41.0 pts); Essendon 0W-5L at MCG this season (avg margin 45.0 pts). Both teams are historically strong at the MCG (Richmond 54%, Essendon 54% all-time), but both have collapsed specifically at this venue in 2026, suggesting environmental or structural issues at the MCG for both teams this year. The gap between historical (54%) and current (0%) performance is abnormal and unpredictable, creating noise.
- Head-to-head equilibrium: Last 6 encounters: Richmond 3W-3L (50% win rate) at exactly 50%. Richmond averaged 78.2 pts for vs Essendon's 66.3 pts across this sample. However, the most recent sequence is L-L-L-W-L, showing Richmond lost 3 consecutive before a win, then a loss. No clear momentum vector.
- Injury severity disparity: Richmond has 18 players on injury list with discussions underway about AFL top-up provisions (critical shortage). Campbell Gray added this week (hamstring); Nick Vlastuin under tribunal scrutiny. Essendon has 1 notable departure (Brayden Fiorini to long-term injury list). Richmond's list depth is demonstrably compromised; Essendon's is not.

SCORING TRENDS ANALYSIS:

Richmond (last 5): 72.0 pts for | 110.2 pts against | Average margin 38.2 pts
Richmond (last 3): 77.7 pts for | 98.3 pts against | Average margin 20.6 pts
Attack trend: Stable | Defence trend: Tightening v (improving)

Essendon (last 5): 79.8 pts for | 121.2 pts against | Average margin 41.4 pts
Essendon (last 3): 76.3 pts for | 116.7 pts against | Average margin 40.4 pts
Attack trend: Stable | Defence trend: Stable (no improvement)

Advantage: Richmond's defence is tightening. Over the last 3 games, Richmond is conceding 11.9 fewer points per game than their 5-game average, while Essendon's concession rate has barely budged (4.5 pts). Both teams' attack is stable and comparable (77.7 vs 76.3 pts), but Richmond's improving defensive efficiency is the key differentiator. Essendon's defence remains porous at 116.7 pts/game over last 3, which is 38.6 points higher than the market's expected total score of 173 (implying each team scores ~86.5 pts). Essendon's recent defensive output suggests they will leak points in this match.

HOME GROUND ADVANTAGE:

Season 2026 win rates:
- Richmond: Home 0/4 (0%) | Away 1/6 (17%)

- Essendon: Home 1/6 (17%) | Away 0/4 (0%)

MCG specific (2026):

- Richmond: 0W-5L (0%) | Avg margin 41.0 pts

- Essendon: 0W-5L (0%) | Avg margin 45.0 pts

MCG historical (all-time):

- Richmond: 431W-373L (54%) | Avg margin +1.7 pts over 804 games

- Essendon: 281W-236L (54%) | Avg margin +4.4 pts over 517 games

Estimated home ground value for this match: Approximately 7-9 points for Richmond as the designated home team. This is at the lower end of the typical 8-15 point AFL home advantage range, reflecting the fact that both teams are performing below historical norms at the MCG in 2026, and Essendon also play "home" matches at the MCG (their second home ground). Richmond's historical MCG performance (54%, +1.7 avg) is marginally weaker than Essendon's (54%, +4.4 avg), but Richmond is the named home side for fixture purposes. The pervasive 0W-5L records at the MCG for both teams this season override historical advantage--both are struggling at this venue regardless of home/away designation.

MARKET & MODEL ANALYSIS:

H2H Market (implied from betting): Essendon \$1.48 (67.6% implied) vs Richmond \$2.67 (37.4% implied). The market prices Essendon as a 67.6% favourite after removing overround. This implies confidence in Essendon based on ladder position parity (both 1W-9L) and Essendon's slightly better percentage (70.58% vs 60.95%).

Line Market: Essendon giving 13.1 points. Market expects total score ~173 pts. Line market implies Essendon +13.1 pts, a substantial edge.

Squiggle Model: Richmond 50.0% | Essendon 50.0% | Expected margin 0.1 pts (essentially a coin flip). Model predicts near-perfect equilibrium.

Disagreement Analysis: The betting market and line market strongly favour Essendon (67.6%, +13.1 pts), while the Squiggle model predicts a dead heat. This is a significant conflict.

Weighting decision: I weighted the Squiggle model at 40% because it incorporates team strength ratings, scoring efficiency, and personnel data without overround bias. The betting market's 67.6% Essendon probability appears inflated relative to the underlying form data: Essendon is 0W-5L in last 5 games vs Richmond's 1W-5L. Richmond's defensive trend is improving while Essendon's is stagnant. The market may be anchored to the early-season ladder position and Essendon's percentage advantage, which has less predictive power than recent form trajectory. The model's 50.0% equilibrium is more defensible given the contradictory signals (Essendon's better percentage vs Richmond's better form momentum).

**FATIGUE & TRAVEL

Round 11 | Perth Stadium | 2026-05-22

Fremantle vs St Kilda

MEDIUM CONFIDENCE

TIP: Fremantle

72% win probability approx. 23pt margin

Fremantle \$1.22 (81.9% implied) | St Kilda \$4.32 (23.1% implied) | Line: Fremantle Dockers giving 27.4 pts

PREDICTED WINNER: Fremantle

WIN PROBABILITY: Fremantle: 72% | St Kilda: 28%

I weighted the Squiggle model (60.4% Fremantle) as the primary anchor, adjusted upward to 72% based on: (1) Fremantle's 5-game winning streak with stable offensive and defensive metrics vs St Kilda's declining attack trend (last 3: 92.3 pts vs last 5: 104.4 pts); (2) Fremantle's dominant Perth Stadium record (5W-0L last 5, 61% all-time) vs St Kilda's poor away record at this venue (4W-6L, -3.6 avg margin); (3) calibration for my documented overweighting of away teams (62% of my errors this season). The betting market's 81.9% implied probability is inflated by overround and was down-weighted accordingly.

PREDICTED MARGIN: ~23 points

The line market's 27.4-point spread is likely overestimating Fremantle's advantage. Anchor: Fremantle's last-5 average margin is +28.0 pts, but this includes the +56-pt demolition of West Coast (outlier). More stable is the last-3 average margin of +12.7 pts (calculated: [+43, +15, +12] ÷ 3). St Kilda's last-5 average margin is +29.2 pts, but attacking trend is declining. I predict ~23 pts as a weighted midpoint between Fremantle's stable recent form (+12-28 pts) and the Squiggle model's 16.3-pt expected margin, with a modest upward adjustment for Perth Stadium home ground effect (estimated +6-8 pts based on historical venue data).

KEY FACTORS:

- Perth Stadium Home Fortress Effect: Fremantle is 5W-0L at Perth Stadium in their last 5 games (avg margin +38.6 pts) and 60W-39L (61% win rate) all-time at this venue, while St Kilda is 4W-6L (40% win rate) and average -3.6 pts margin historically. This venue imbalance alone is worth ~10 points in Fremantle's favour.
- Current Form Momentum vs Declining Trend: Fremantle has won 5 consecutive games with stable attack (101.2 pts avg, last 5) and stable defence (73.2 pts conceded). St Kilda has won 3 of 5 but their attacking trend is "declining" -- scoring 92.3 pts avg in last 3 vs 104.4 pts in last 5, a drop of -12.1 pts per game. This suggests St Kilda's recent wins were not predictive of sustained performance.
- Ladder Position & Win-Loss Record Disparity: Fremantle is ranked 2nd (9W-1L, 36 pts) with a +23 percentage point differential (134.94%), while St Kilda is ranked 9th (5W-5L, 20 pts) with a +12.80 differential. The 4-win gap and significantly superior point differential signal a material quality gap beyond margin noise.
- Injury Impact to St Kilda's Forward Line: Jack Higgins (17 goals this season, "crucial" to forward line) is flagged "no guarantee" due to knee soreness, creating selection uncertainty. Fremantle's loss of Hayden Young to concussion protocols is offset by the note that the break may be "advantageous in the long run" and is a 2-round absence, not acutely impacting this match's intensity. St Kilda's forward line uncertainty is a direct, quantifiable reduction in scoring capacity.

SCORING TRENDS ANALYSIS:

Fremantle (last 5): 101.2 pts for | 73.2 pts against | Attack trend: stable | Defence trend: stable

Fremantle (last 3): 102.0 pts for | 78.7 pts against (defence softened marginally but within variance)

St Kilda (last 5): 104.4 pts for | 75.2 pts against | Attack trend: declining v | Defence trend: stable

St Kilda (last 3): 92.3 pts for | 77.0 pts against (attack dropped -12.1 pts per game)

Advantage: Fremantle. St Kilda's offensive scoring is trending downward in the most recent 3 games, with no corresponding improvement in defensive efficiency. Fremantle's attack is stable and their defence is holding firm. In contests between a declining attack and stable defence (St Kilda) versus a stable attack and stable defence (Fremantle), the team with momentum and consistency wins point-scoring battles. St Kilda's last-5 average of 104.4 is inflated by the outlier +101-pt win over West Coast (143-42); their more realistic baseline is ~92 pts.

HOME GROUND ADVANTAGE:

Fremantle this season:

- Home: 4W-4L (100%)
- Away: 5W-6L (83%)
- Home advantage this season: +17 percentage points

St Kilda this season:

- Home: 2W-4L (50%)
- Away: 3W-6L (50%)
- Home advantage this season: 0 percentage points (no advantage detected)

At Perth Stadium specifically:

- Fremantle (last 5 games): 5W-0L, avg margin +38.6 pts
- Fremantle (all-time, 99 games): 60W-39L (61%), avg 78.9 vs 72.8 (margin +6.2)
- St Kilda (last 5 games): 3W-2L, avg margin +2.0 pts
- St Kilda (all-time, 10 games): 4W-6L (40%), avg 77.0 vs 80.6 (margin -3.6)

Estimated home ground value this match: ~8-10 points in Fremantle's favour. This is consistent with the AFL baseline (8-15 pts for fortress venues), and Fremantle's Perth Stadium record (61% all-time, 100% last 5) qualifies as a fortress. St Kilda's 40% all-time record and negative average margin at this venue compounds Fremantle's advantage.

MARKET & MODEL ANALYSIS:

Betting Market (H2H): Fremantle \$1.22 (81.9% implied) vs St Kilda \$4.32 (23.1% implied)

- The market strongly favours Fremantle, but the implied probabilities include overround (bookmaker margin). Removing ~5% overround: Fremantle 78-80%, St Kilda ~20-22%.

Betting Market (Line): Fremantle giving 27.4 pts

- This is higher than my predicted margin of ~23 pts, suggesting the market may be slightly overvaluing Fremantle's advantage. However, the line market and H2H market are not contradictory--both point to a Fremantle win.

Squiggle Model: Fremantle 60.4% to win | Expected margin 16.3 pts

- The Squiggle model is more conservative than the betting market, suggesting a narrower margin. This is the most objective data source and should be treated as a baseline.

Cross-check:

- Market (adjusted for overround): Fremantle 78-80%
- Squiggle: Fremantle 60.4%
- Form data: Fremantle 5W-0L, St Kilda 3W-5L
- Disagreement: The betting market is significantly more confident in Fremantle than Squiggle. This likely reflects: (1) overround inflation; (2) market recency bias toward Fremantle's 5-game streak; (3) Perth Stadium home advantage being underweighted by Squiggle's historical model.

My weighting: I leaned 60% toward Squiggle's conservative baseline (60.4%) and adjusted upward 12 percentage points to 72% to account for Perth Stadium home ground advantage

Round 11 | Docklands | 2026-05-23

North Melbourne vs Gold Coast

MEDIUM CONFIDENCE

TIP: Gold Coast

63% win probability approx. 12pt margin

North Melbourne \$2.45 (40.8% implied) | Gold Coast \$1.56 (64.3% implied) | Line: Gold Coast Suns giving 10.5 pts

NORTH MELBOURNE VS GOLD COAST | ROUND 11 | 2026-05-23

PREDICTED WINNER: Gold Coast

WIN PROBABILITY: North Melbourne: 37% | Gold Coast: 63%

(Derived from weighted blend: Squiggle model 59.1% Gold Coast (40% weight), betting market 64.3% Gold Coast adjusted for overround (35% weight), recent form and ladder position (25% weight). The model and market converge on Gold Coast despite North's home advantage, signalling strong agreement on the favourite.)

PREDICTED MARGIN: ~12 points

(Squiggle model predicts 13.8 pts; line market sets Gold Coast at 10.5 pts. North's last-5 average margin is -11.4 pts against, while Gold Coast's is +6.8 pts. Splitting the difference between model and market with a slight lean to the model's methodological rigour gives ~12 pts.)

KEY FACTORS:

- Defensive deterioration (North) vs defensive tightening (Gold Coast): North's defence conceded an average of 124.3 pts in the last 3 games (vs 82.7 for themselves), a trend marked as "leaking more ^". Gold Coast's defence conceded 65.3 pts average in the last 3, marked as "tightening v". This 59-point differential in Gold Coast's defensive efficiency in recent form is decisive.
- Ladder position and win-loss differential: Gold Coast sits at 4th (7W-3L, 28 pts) with a +20.27 percentage point differential. North sits at 12th (4W-6L, 16 pts) with a -3.34 percentage point differential. The 4-win gap and 12-point separation in ladder positions reflects a material quality gap.
- Head-to-head historical pattern: In the last 7 meetings, North has won only 2 of 7 (29% win rate) against Gold Coast, averaging 72.6 pts for vs 108.7 pts against--a 36.1 point deficit. While venue and recency matter, this long-term H2H suggests structural competitive imbalance.
- Recent form momentum: Gold Coast has won 4 of the last 5 games with an average margin of +6.8 pts. North has won only 1 of the last 5 with an average margin of -11.4 pts. The directional gap (18.2 points in recent momentum) combined with Gold Coast's tightening defence creates a compounding advantage.

SCORING TRENDS ANALYSIS:

North Melbourne (last 5): 95.2 pts for, 106.6 pts against | (last 3): 82.7 pts for, 124.3 pts against

- Attack trend: declining v (down 12.5 pts from L5 to L3)
- Defence trend: leaking more ^ (conceding +17.7 pts from L5 to L3)

Gold Coast (last 5): 90.4 pts for, 83.6 pts against | (last 3): 90.0 pts for, 65.3 pts against

- Attack trend: stable (90.4 -> 90.0, negligible change)
- Defence trend: tightening v (conceding -18.3 pts from L5 to L3)

Advantage: Gold Coast. North is moving in both wrong directions simultaneously; their attacking potency is shrinking while their defensive fragility is expanding. Gold Coast maintains offensive consistency while dramatically improving defensive control. The 59-point gap in recent defensive performance (North conceding 124.3 vs Gold Coast conceding 65.3) heavily favours Gold Coast's ability to manage North's reduced attacking threat.

HOME GROUND ADVANTAGE:

North Melbourne (this season):

- Home: 3W-2L (60% win rate)
- Away: 1W-4L (20% win rate)
- Home advantage: +40 percentage points

Gold Coast (this season):

- Home: 6W-0L (100% win rate)
- Away: 1W-3L (25% win rate)
- Home advantage: +75 percentage points

At Docklands (last 5 games):

- North Melbourne: 4W-1L, avg margin +27.0 pts
- Gold Coast: 4W-1L, avg margin +13.8 pts

Historical at Docklands:

- North Melbourne: 131W-142L (48% win rate), avg margin -0.7 pts over 273 games
- Gold Coast: 13W-28L (32% win rate), avg margin -21.3 pts over 41 games

Estimate: North's home ground advantage is significant (+40pp this season). However, Gold Coast's recent Docklands record (4 wins in last 5) and the general AFL home ground value of 8-15 pts suggest North gains approximately +12 to +15 pts from playing at home. This partially offsets Gold Coast's ladder superiority but does not eliminate it. Gold Coast's away record (25%) is weak, but their recent form at this specific venue contradicts the historical trend, suggesting they may have contextually adapted to Docklands.

MARKET & MODEL ANALYSIS:

- Head-to-head market: North \$2.45 (40.8% implied) | Gold Coast \$1.56 (64.3% implied) -- market favour Gold Coast by ~23.5 percentage points after removing overround.
- Line market: Gold Coast -10.5 pts (market's expected margin).
- Squiggle model: Gold Coast to win by 13.8 pts; win probability North 40.9%, Gold Coast 59.1%.

Agreement/Disagreement:

- Market and Squiggle agree directionally (both favour Gold Coast).
- They diverge slightly on magnitude: the line market is more conservative (-10.5 pts) than Squiggle (-13.8 pts), though within typical variance.
- The market may be slightly overvaluing North's home ground advantage relative to form differentials.

Weighting: I weighted Squiggle 40%, market 35%, and form/ladder data 25%. Squiggle's model-based approach captures structural performance more reliably than market prices, which embed sentiment and bookmaker margin. However, the market's agreement with the Squiggle direction (both Gold Coast) raises confidence in the favourite.

FATIGUE & TRAVEL IMPACT:

- North Melbourne (home): 7 days rest. Playing at home. No travel fatigue.
- Gold Coast (away): 8 days rest. Moderate travel (Gold Coast -> Melbourne, ~2h30m flight). Minimal fatigue given extra day of rest.

Assessment: Fatigue is not a material factor in this match. Both teams have adequate rest (7+ days), and the flight time is routine AFL travel. Gold Coast's extra day of rest (8 vs 7) is trivial. No adjustment warranted.

WEATHER IMPACT:

Marvel Stadium has a retractable roof. Weather conditions will not affect play. This is neutral for both teams. No scoring style advantage accrues to either side.

TEAM NEWS IMPACT:

No relevant team news found in the last 7 days for either North Melbourne or Gold Coast. No confirmed ins/outs, injuries, or suspensions reported. Analysis must rely on form data, ladder position, and venue records only. This is a neutral factor but limits context for any unexpected performance deviations.

CONFIDENCE: Medium

(Squiggle model and betting market converge strongly on Gold Coast (59-64%), and recent form favours Gold Coast decisively (4W-1L vs 1W-5L). However, North's home ground advantage is significant (+40pp this season), and their recent Docklands record (4W-1L in last 5) contradicts historical weakness there. Additionally, no team news is available, which introduces uncertainty about late-breaking roster impacts. The 12-13 point margin is not overwhelming, leaving room for North's home advantage to narrow the gap materially. Medium confidence reflects alignment on direction but uncertainty on magnitude.)

**UPSET

Round 11 | Kardinia Park | 2026-05-23

Geelong vs Sydney

MEDIUM CONFIDENCE

TIP: Geelong

72% win probability approx. 28pt margin

Geelong \$1.57 (63.7% implied) | Sydney \$2.42 (41.3% implied) | Line: Geelong Cats giving 10.5 pts

PREDICTED WINNER: Geelong

WIN PROBABILITY: Geelong: 72% | Sydney: 28%

I weighted three sources: Squiggle model (70% Geelong, treated as 40% of final estimate), betting market win line (63.7% Geelong, treated as 30% of final estimate), and adjusted form/venue data (75% Geelong, treated as 30% of final estimate). The three sources align directionally; I elevated the final probability above the market to account for Kardinia Park venue dominance and recent form, which the market may underweight.

PREDICTED MARGIN: ~28 points

Anchor: Squiggle expected margin of 31.8 pts; betting line of 10.5 pts; Geelong's last-5 average margin of +37.8 pts; Sydney's last-5 average margin of +27.6 pts; Geelong's Kardinia Park historical average margin of +18.1 pts; and Sydney's Kardinia Park historical average margin of -17.1 pts (indicating structural venue disadvantage). At Kardinia Park specifically, the gap is material: Geelong averages +18.1, Sydney averages -17.1, a 35-point difference in expected outcomes by venue. The 28-point prediction sits between the Squiggle estimate and venue-adjusted form, reflecting high confidence but not overconfidence.

KEY FACTORS:

1. Kardinia Park Fortress Effect (Quantified): Geelong's record at Kardinia Park is 5W-0L in the last 5 games with an average margin of +37.2 pts. Sydney's record at Kardinia Park is 0W-1L with an average margin of -93.0 pts. Historically, Geelong wins 68% at Kardinia

Park (496W-236L over 732 games, avg +18.1 margin), while Sydney wins only 34% (22W-43L over 65 games, avg -17.1 margin). This venue differential is the largest single factor in the analysis.

2. Recent Form Momentum (Last 3 Games): Geelong has won 3/3 with an average margin of +49 pts (124.7 for, 76.7 against). Sydney has won 5/5 but with a tightening trend: last-3 average margin is only +5.2 pts (105.7 for, 95.3 against), down from last-5 average of +27.6 pts. Sydney's defence is leaking more (82.4 against last-5 -> 95.3 against last-3, a 12.9-point deterioration). Geelong's form is improving in both attack and margin size.

3. Home Ground Advantage Structural Pattern: Geelong's season home/away split is 6W-0L at home (100%) vs 1W-4L away (20%), a 80-point swing. Sydney's split is 6W-0L at home (100%) vs 3W-4L away (43%), a 57-point swing. Both teams are significantly stronger at home, but this match at Kardinia Park nullifies Sydney's home advantage (which Geelong negates) while amplifying Geelong's home advantage. The net effect favours Geelong by approximately 12-18 points beyond neutral conditions.

4. Head-to-Head Trajectory: Geelong's last 6 H2H record is 4W-2L (67% win rate) with an average score of 97.8 (Geelong) vs 71.7 (Sydney). The last 5 sequence is W-L-W-W-W, showing dominant recent form against Sydney. Sydney has not won at Kardinia Park in the data window (0/1).

SCORING TRENDS ANALYSIS:

Geelong (Last 5): 114.0 pts for, 76.2 pts against. Last 3: 124.7 pts for, 76.7 pts against. Attack trend: improving ^ Defence trend: stable. The 10.7-point increase in average scoring (last 3 vs last 5) indicates offensive momentum. Defence remains consistent.

Sydney (Last 5): 110.0 pts for, 82.4 pts against. Last 3: 105.7 pts for, 95.3 pts against. Attack trend: stable. Defence trend: leaking more ^. Sydney's offence has declined by 4.3 pts/game (last 3 vs last 5), and defence has deteriorated sharply by 12.9 pts/game, suggesting vulnerability.

Advantage: Geelong. Geelong is improving offensively while maintaining defence; Sydney is both declining offensively and regressing defensively. In a match where Geelong's average margin is +37.8 and Sydney's is +27.6, Geelong's current trajectory is moving in the right direction while Sydney's is not.

HOME GROUND ADVANTAGE:

Geelong Season Record: 6W-0L at home (100%); 1W-4L away (20%). Home advantage: 80 percentage points.

Sydney Season Record: 6W-0L at home (100%); 3W-4L away (43%). Home advantage: 57 percentage points.

Geelong at Kardinia Park (Last 5 games): 5W-0L, average margin +37.2 pts.

Sydney at Kardinia Park (Historical): 22W-43L (34% win rate), average margin -17.1 pts. (Most recent visit: 1 loss.)

Geelong at Kardinia Park (Historical): 496W-236L (68% win rate), average margin +18.1 pts, over 732 games.

Estimated Home Ground Point Value: AFL home ground advantage is typically valued at 8-15 points for fortress venues. Kardinia Park, with Geelong's 68% win rate and +18.1 average margin, is a fortress. Sydney's 34% win rate and -17.1 average margin at the same venue suggests structural disadvantage. The differential (68% vs 34%, +18.1 vs -17.1) indicates Geelong's home advantage is worth approximately 15-20 points above neutral, while Sydney's away disadvantage compounds the structural gap.

MARKET & MODEL ANALYSIS:

Win Line Market: Geelong \$1.57 (63.7% implied), Sydney \$2.42 (41.3% implied). The market favours Geelong but does not imply a decisive edge (63.7% is not overwhelming).

Line Market: Geelong giving 10.5 pts. This is substantially lower than Squiggle's 31.8 or the Kardinia Park historical differential of 35 points (68% vs 34% win rate). The line market may be underweighting venue advantage.

Squiggle Model: 70% Geelong win, 31.8 pt expected margin. This is the most aggressive Geelong forecast in the data.

Agreement & Conflict: The model and win line agree (both favour Geelong), but the margin estimates differ sharply. Squiggle's 31.8 margin is 3× the line market's 10.5 pts. I interpret this as: the market acknowledges Geelong is favoured but is uncertain about magnitude, while Squiggle's historical patterns (likely including venue data) assign much higher confidence to a larger margin. Given Kardinia Park's documented 68% win rate for Geelong and Sydney's 34%, I weighted Squiggle's margin estimate more heavily and elevated my prediction accordingly.

FATIGUE & TRAVEL IMPACT:

Geelong (Home): 9 days rest. No travel fatigue.

Sydney (Away): 8 days rest. Short travel: Sydney -> Geelong (~1 hour 25 minutes flight).

Assessment: Both teams have adequate rest (8-9 days). Sydney's travel is short and non-demanding. Fatigue is not a material factor in this match. Sydney's 1-day rest disadvantage is negligible in AFL context (typical rest differences are 4-6 days). No meaningful impact on prediction.

WEATHER IMPACT:

Forecast: Max 17°C, 0.0 mm rain (0% chance), 14 km/h wind at GM

Round 11 | MCG | 2026-05-23

Collingwood vs West Coast

MEDIUM CONFIDENCE

TIP: Collingwood

77% win probability approx. 41pt margin

Collingwood \$1.08 (92.8% implied) | West Coast \$8.32 (12.0% implied) | Line: Collingwood Magpies giving 43.6 pts

PREDICTED WINNER: Collingwood

WIN PROBABILITY: Collingwood: 77% | West Coast: 23%

Weighted blend: Squiggle model (76.2% Collingwood, weight 40%) + betting market adjusted for overround (92.8% implied, weight 30%, reducing to ~75% true probability) + recent H2H dominance and home venue record (weight 30%). The three sources show strong agreement on Collingwood favouritism.

PREDICTED MARGIN: ~41 points

The line market expects 43.6 pts; Squiggle model expects 44.4 pts. Both align closely. Collingwood's average margin in last 5 games is +4.4 pts, but this is heavily skewed by the 77-pt win vs Essendon; removing outliers, recent margins are closer to +5-10 pts. However, West Coast's catastrophic form (average margin last 5: -36.6 pts) and MCG venue record (0W-5L, average margin -32.4 pts over last 5) support a wide margin. Conservative anchor: 41 pts splits the model and market expectations.

KEY FACTORS:

1. Venue history (MCG): Collingwood 54% win rate (388-333) vs West Coast 39% win rate (36-57) at this ground. Over 93 MCG games, West Coast averages a -7.9 pt margin, while Collingwood averages +4.4 pts. This specific venue represents a 12-point structural advantage to Collingwood.

2. Recent head-to-head dominance: Collingwood 3W-1L against West Coast in last 4 meetings (75% win rate). Last 3 encounters (2023-2025) show Collingwood averaging 96.2 pts vs West Coast's 60.0 pts -- a 36.2 pt average margin. This pattern is not driven by West Coast's home ground; Collingwood won 88-59 at Docklands (neutral venue) in 2025 and 103-37 at Docklands in 2024.
3. West Coast's season-long away record: 1W-5L (20% win rate) vs Collingwood's home record of 1W-4L (25%). While Collingwood's home record appears weak, they perform 25 percentage points better away (3W-6L, 50% win rate), suggesting they are vulnerable at the MCG this season. However, West Coast's away record is significantly worse, and the MCG specifically is a fortress for Collingwood (historical 54% win rate) and a graveyard for West Coast (historical 39% win rate).
4. Scoring trend divergence (last 3 games): Collingwood's attack declining to 78.7 pts and defence leaking 98.7 pts against, vs West Coast's attack improving to 81.0 pts and defence tightening to 89.7 pts conceded. West Coast shows marginal improvement, but their absolute baseline (65.2 pts for over 5 games) remains 27 pts below Collingwood's average (92.2 pts for). The defensive improvement is notable but insufficient to overcome the scoring gap.

SCORING TRENDS ANALYSIS:

Collingwood (last 5): 92.2 pts for, 87.8 pts against. (Last 3): 78.7 pts for, 98.7 pts against.

- Attack trend: Declining v (92.2 -> 78.7, -13.5 pts drop)
- Defence trend: Deteriorating ^ (87.8 -> 98.7, +10.9 pts conceded)

West Coast (last 5): 65.2 pts for, 101.8 pts against. (Last 3): 81.0 pts for, 89.7 pts against.

- Attack trend: Improving ^ (65.2 -> 81.0, +15.8 pts gain)
- Defence trend: Tightening v (101.8 -> 89.7, -12.1 pts improvement)

Advantage: Collingwood, despite the declining trend in the last 3 games. West Coast's "improvement" over 3 games brings them to 81.0 pts for and 89.7 pts against -- still well below Collingwood's season average of 92.2 pts for. The gap remains ~11 pts in Collingwood's favour on attack. West Coast's defensive improvement is real but takes them from "historically bad" (101.8) to merely "below average" (89.7). Collingwood's defence remains superior at 98.7 conceded vs West Coast's 89.7, but West Coast's trajectory is more positive. However, trajectory does not overcome absolute current performance.

HOME GROUND ADVANTAGE:

Collingwood (Season): Home 1W-4L (25%) | Away 3W-6L (50%). Paradox: Collingwood performs 25 percentage points better away than at home.

West Coast (Season): Home 2W-5L (40%) | Away 1W-5L (20%). West Coast is 20 percentage points stronger at home.

MCG Specific (last 5 games):

- Collingwood: 2W-3L, average margin +2.8 pts
- West Coast: 0W-5L, average margin -32.4 pts

MCG Historical (all-time):

- Collingwood: 388W-333L (54% win rate, avg margin +4.4 pts) over 721 games
- West Coast: 36W-57L (39% win rate, avg margin -7.9 pts) over 93 games

Home Ground Advantage Estimate: Standard AFL home ground advantage is 8-15 pts. However, the MCG is a high-attendance fortress (~100,000 capacity) that typically amplifies crowd advantage. Collingwood's 54% historical MCG win rate and +4.4 pt margin suggest they gain ~12 pts from playing at home. West Coast's 39% historical MCG record and -7.9 pt average margin suggest they lose ~12 pts away at the MCG. Net advantage to Collingwood: +24 pts (Collingwood +12 from home + West Coast -12 from away at MCG).

However, this season Collingwood are underperforming at home (25% win rate) while outperforming away (50% win rate). This contradicts their historical pattern and may indicate tactical or personnel issues in their home setup. Nonetheless, West Coast's away record (20% win rate) is catastrophic, and the MCG specifically is statistically their worst venue.

MARKET & MODEL ANALYSIS:

H2H Market (Win/Loss): Collingwood \$1.08 implied 92.8% | West Coast \$8.32 implied 12.0%. The market overround is ~4.8% (sums to 104.8), so true probabilities are approximately: Collingwood 88-90%, West Coast 10-12%.

Line Market: Collingwood giving 43.6 pts (expected margin).

Squiggle Model: Collingwood 76.2% | West Coast 23.8%, expected margin 44.4 pts.

Agreement Assessment: The line market (43.6 pts) and Squiggle model (44.4 pts) are nearly identical. The H2H market (92.8% Collingwood) is more aggressive on Collingwood than the Squiggle model (76.2%). This discrepancy suggests the market may be overweighting either: (a) Collingwood's historical dominance in H2H, or (b) home ground advantage. Squiggle's 76.2% is more conservative and accounts for West Coast's recent form improvement and Collingwood's weak home-ground record this season (1W-4L at home).

Weight distribution: I weighted Squiggle at 40% (most robust statistical model), adjusted betting market at 30% (correcting for overround), and form/H2H/venue at 30%. Final: 77% Collingwood, 23% West Coast. This is slightly more conservative

Round 11 | Adelaide Oval | 2026-05-23

Port Adelaide vs Carlton

MEDIUM CONFIDENCE

TIP: Carlton

54% win probability approx. 5pt margin

Port Adelaide \$1.59 (63.0% implied) | Carlton \$2.36 (42.4% implied) | Line: Port Adelaide Power giving 8.6 pts

PORT ADELAIDE vs CARLTON | ROUND 11 | 2026-05-23

PREDICTED WINNER: Carlton

WIN PROBABILITY: Port Adelaide: 46% | Carlton: 54%

Derived from: Squiggle model (51.3% Carlton) weighted at 45%, betting market adjusted for overround (42.4% -> 48% Carlton) weighted at 25%, and recent form differential weighted at 30%. Squiggle receives highest weight because it integrates season-long data and corrects for recency bias; market probability includes overround and is used as a cross-check only. Form data (both teams 1-5 in last 5 games) is nearly equivalent, so the separation comes from venue-specific patterns and the model's statistical edge.

PREDICTED MARGIN: ~3-5 points (Carlton by)

Anchor: Squiggle model predicts 2.1 pts Carlton; betting line market sets Port Adelaide as 8.6 pt favourite (implying market expects Port Adelaide +8.6). The 10-point gap between these two signals reflects genuine uncertainty. Scoring averages show Port Adelaide averaging 80.2 for/80.4 against (last 5), Carlton 80.8 for/92.2 against. Carlton's defensive weakness (allowing 92.2 pts avg) is offset by their modest attacking output (80.8 pts), suggesting low-scoring margin wins are typical for this Carlton team. The Squiggle prediction of a 2-point margin is more credible than the market's 8.6-point Port Adelaide line, which appears overweighting home ground advantage without accounting for Carlton's recent momentum (1-1 in last 2) and Port Adelaide's last-3 defensive fragility (82.7 pts conceded avg).

KEY FACTORS:

1. Home ground advantage is real but likely overpriced by the market. Port Adelaide are 2/5 at home (40%) vs 1/5 away (20%) this season (+20pp), and historically 63% at home. However, at Adelaide Oval specifically, Port Adelaide's record is 1W-4L in the last 5

games (20% win rate), contradicting the all-time 61% figure. Carlton at Adelaide Oval historically: 3W-10L (23% win rate, -35.8 pt avg margin). The betting market's 8.6-point Port Adelaide line assumes fortress advantage, but recent venue data suggests erosion of this advantage.

2. Carlton's defensive vulnerability is being ignored by the market. Carlton conceded 92.2 pts average (last 5) and 90.0 pts (last 3). Port Adelaide's attack has been stable at 80.2 pts last 5. If Port Adelaide reaches their average (80.2 pts) and Carlton's defence concedes to form (92.2 pts allowed), Port Adelaide would win 80-92 by default. However, Carlton's attacking output is also weak (80.8 pts last 5), limiting ceiling. The market is pricing this as a Port Adelaide blowout, but the scoring data suggests a low-scoring contest where defence, not attack, determines the winner.

3. Recent form sequence favours Carlton marginally. Port Adelaide: L-L-L-W-L (1/5). Carlton: W-L-L-L-L (1/5). Carlton's most recent result is a +12 pt win vs Western Bulldogs (2026-05-16); Port Adelaide's most recent is a -25 pt loss to Gold Coast (2026-05-15). Recency bias alone would favour Carlton, but both teams are in identical 1-5 form slumps. Squiggle's 51.3% Carlton likely reflects Carlton's marginal recency edge and lower pre-match expectations (underdog status).

4. Head-to-head pattern shows Carlton have edge at Adelaide Oval (venue-specific). Last 6 meetings: Port Adelaide 2W-4L. At Adelaide Oval specifically (last 5 meetings): Port Adelaide 1W-4L, with Carlton's historical win rate at this venue (23%, 3/13) being the baseline. Port Adelaide's all-time home record (61%) suggests they should dominate here, but the recent venue data contradicts this. Carlton are not a traditional Adelaide Oval threat, but current form suggests they are performing well outside their typical profile.

SCORING TRENDS ANALYSIS:

Port Adelaide (last 5): 80.2 pts for, 80.4 pts against. Last 3: 73.3 pts for, 82.7 pts against. Attack trend: stable. Defence trend: stable. Carlton (last 5): 80.8 pts for, 92.2 pts against. Last 3: 77.3 pts for, 90.0 pts against. Attack trend: stable. Defence trend: stable.

Advantage analysis: Both teams' attacks are nearly identical in output (Port 80.2 vs Carlton 80.8) and both are stable. The decisive factor is defence: Carlton concedes 11.8 pts more per game (92.2 vs 80.4) than Port Adelaide across the last 5 rounds. Port Adelaide's defensive stability suggests they will contain Carlton's attack near the 80-pt mark. Carlton's leaky defence (90.0 pts conceded last 3) means Port Adelaide should score in their usual range (~80 pts). This scoring profile suggests a match where Port Adelaide scores ~80 pts and Carlton scores ~80 pts -- a genuine coin-flip outcome that slightly favours Carlton because Squiggle's model has integrated factors not visible in raw scoring averages (e.g., disposal efficiency, pressure metrics, turnover differential).

HOME GROUND ADVANTAGE:

Port Adelaide season record: Home 2/5 (40%), Away 1/5 (20%). Home ground advantage observed: +20 percentage points. Carlton season record: Home 2/5 (40%), Away 0/5 (0%). Home ground advantage observed: +40 percentage points.

Venue-specific records:

- Port Adelaide at Adelaide Oval (last 5): 1W-4L (+2.2 pt avg margin). Historical (all-time, 157 games): 96W-61L (61% win rate, +13.3 pt avg margin, 88.8 vs 75.4 scoring).
- Carlton at Adelaide Oval (last 5): 2W-3L (-6.2 pt avg margin). Historical (all-time, 13 games): 3W-10L (23% win rate, -35.8 pt avg margin, 68.1 vs 103.8 scoring).

Home ground advantage estimate for this match: AFL fortress venues typically confer 8-15 pt advantage. Port Adelaide's historical +13.3 pt margin at Adelaide Oval suggests 12-13 pts of venue value. However, recent venue data contradicts this: Port Adelaide's last 5 at home shows only +2.2 pt average margin, a 11-point erosion from the all-time average. This erosion is material and suggests the current Port Adelaide team does not access the full fortress benefit. Carlton's away record is historically catastrophic (23%, -35.8 pts), but their recent away performance at Adelaide (2/5, -6.2 pt avg) suggests marginal improvement.

Net estimate: Port Adelaide should retain 6-8 pts of home advantage (down from 12-13 pts historically), reducing the effective line market advantage from 8.6 pts to approximately 6-7 pts in true advantage terms. The market's 8.6-point line may be overweighting historical fortress data and underweighting recent venue erosion.

MARKET & MODEL ANALYSIS:

Head-to-head market: Betting markets price Port Adelaide at \$1.59 (63% implied) and Carlton at \$2.36 (42.4% implied). This implies an 8-point Port Adelaide favourite (line market). The h2h market strongly favours Port Adelaide.

Line market: Port Adelaide giving 8.6 pts. This is consistent with h2h odds and reflects the sportsbook's expectation of a comfortable Port Adelaide home win.

Squiggle model: Carlton to win by 2.1 pts. Model win probabilities: Port Adelaide 48.7%, Carlton 51.3%. This contradicts the betting market materially -- a 14-point swing in implied probability (Carlton from 42.4% market to 51.3% model)

Round 11 | Sydney Showground | 2026-05-24

GWS Giants vs Brisbane Lions

MEDIUM CONFIDENCE

TIP: Brisbane Lions 62% win probability approx. 8pt margin

GWS Giants \$2.75 (36.4% implied) | Brisbane Lions \$1.45 (68.8% implied) | Line: Brisbane Lions giving 14.8 pts

PREDICTED WINNER: Brisbane Lions

WIN PROBABILITY: GWS Giants: 38% | Brisbane Lions: 62%

Weighting: 45% recent form/scoring trends, 30% home ground advantage (heavily favours GWS), 15% betting market (adjusted downward from 68.8% to account for systematic overround), 10% H2H history. The market's 68.8% implied probability for Brisbane was reduced to 62% because GWS's exceptional home record (80% this season, +15pp multi-year advantage) creates genuine offset despite Brisbane's superior recent scoring profile.

PREDICTED MARGIN: ~Brisbane Lions by 8 points

Justification: Market line is Brisbane by 14.8 pts. However, GWS's home record at Sydney Showground (3W-2L, +5.8 pt avg margin over last 5 games; 66W-43L 61% win rate historically with +7.0 pt avg margin) suggests home advantage will compress Brisbane's edge. Brisbane's last-5 average margin is +16.8 pts, but Brisbane historically performs worse away (40% win rate vs 60% at home, -20pp swing). Blending these: Brisbane's true form advantage (~10 pts) minus GWS home venue compression (~5-7 pts) yields ~8 pt margin.

KEY FACTORS:

- GWS Home Fortress (80% home win rate vs 0% away this season): GWS is 4W-5L overall but 4W-0L at home this season. Playing at Sydney Showground where they hold 66W-43L historical record with +7.0 pt avg margin. This is the single largest positive factor for GWS and directly contradicts their overall ladder position weakness.
- Brisbane's Recent Scoring Dominance (109.6 pts for, +16.8 pt avg margin last 5 games): Brisbane has scored 100+ in 4 of last 5 games (143, 127, 100, and 102 pts) vs GWS averaging 81.6 pts for and 93.0 pts against. This 28-point gap in scoring firepower is substantial and favours Brisbane regardless of venue.

3. Contradictory H2H Record (GWS 3W-4L but averaging identical scores 92.0 vs 91.6): Last 7 H2H shows GWS at 43% win rate, yet the teams score virtually identically on average. At Sydney Showground specifically, GWS is 3W-2L (60%) while Brisbane is 1W-0L (sample size n=1, not reliable). This signals H2H data is weak signal -- form is more informative.
4. Rest & Travel Advantage Brisbane (10 days rest vs GWS's 7 days; short 1h30m travel): Brisbane has longer recovery post-Geelong loss and minimal travel fatigue. GWS has adequate rest but Brisbane's extra 3 days may compound Brisbane's already superior form trend.

SCORING TRENDS ANALYSIS:

- GWS Giants:
- Last 5: 81.6 pts for, 93.0 pts against (avg margin -11.4 pts)
 - Last 3: 79.0 pts for, 86.7 pts against (avg margin -7.7 pts)
 - Attack trend: Stable | Defence trend: Stable
 - Profile: Offensively struggling (79-81 pts range is low); defensively leaky (86-93 pts conceded). Last-3 shows minor improvement in defence but attack remains suppressed.
- Brisbane Lions:
- Last 5: 109.6 pts for, 92.8 pts against (avg margin +16.8 pts)
 - Last 3: 106.3 pts for, 95.0 pts against (avg margin +11.3 pts)
 - Attack trend: Stable | Defence trend: Stable
 - Profile: Dominant offensive output (106-110 pts); solid defence (92-95 pts conceded). Last-3 shows slight defensive softening (95 vs 92.8) but attack remains elite.
- Advantage: Brisbane by significant margin. Brisbane's scoring consistency at 106+ pts directly targets GWS's weak defence (86-93 pts conceded). GWS cannot replicate Brisbane's output; even their best recent performance (103 pts vs Essendon) falls short of Brisbane's average. This is the clearest edge in the match.
-

HOME GROUND ADVANTAGE:

- GWS Giants this season:
- Home: 4W-5L (80% -- note: this is 4 wins from 5 games, not 4 from 5 total)
 - Away: 0W-5L (0%)
 - Home ground advantage: +80pp swing -- this is extraordinary and the most dramatic single statistic in the dataset.
- Brisbane Lions this season:
- Home: 3W-5L (60%)
 - Away: 3W-5L (60%)
 - No home/away split -- Brisbane's form is venue-independent.
- GWS Giants at Sydney Showground:
- Last 5 games: 3W-2L (60%) | avg margin +5.8 pts
 - Historical (all-time): 66W-43L (61% win rate) | avg margin +7.0 pts (GWS 92.0 vs Brisbane 85.0)
 - Clear fortress: +7.0 pt home advantage historically
- Brisbane Lions at Sydney Showground:
- Last 1 game: 1W (n=1, unreliable)
 - Historical: 3W-3L (50% win rate) | avg margin -6.8 pts (Brisbane 78.7 vs GWS 85.5)
 - Brisbane historically struggles here: -6.8 pt away disadvantage
- Estimated home advantage for this match: +7 to +8 pts to GWS. AFL typical home advantage is 8-15 pts; GWS's specific venue data suggests ~7 pts here. This directly compresses the betting line (14.8 pts) and explains why GWS's poor overall form (0W-5L away) is misleading -- they are a different team at home.

MARKET & MODEL ANALYSIS:

H2H Implied (Win/Loss): GWS Giants \$2.75 (36.4% implied) vs Brisbane Lions \$1.45 (68.8% implied).

- Market implies Brisbane 32.4pp favourite. Market is repricing recent form (Brisbane 3W-2 last 5, GWS 2W-3) and ignoring GWS home venue data as an edge.

Line Market: Brisbane giving 14.8 pts.

- Market expects Brisbane +14.8 pt margin. This is higher than Brisbane's last-5 average margin of +16.8 pts, suggesting market is slightly discounting Brisbane or pricing in some GWS home advantage (but not enough -- see analysis below).

Squiggle Model: Not provided for this match.

- Data gap: No model prediction available. Reduces confidence slightly but does not change analysis direction.

Market Disagreement Analysis:

- Win/loss market (68.8% Brisbane) and line market (+14.8 Brisbane) are not internally consistent. A 14.8 pt line typically implies 65-68% win probability (market is correctly calibrated here), but the 68.8% win probability should map to ~16 pt line, not 14.8 pt. This suggests market is conflicted -- slightly underweighting Brisbane's scoring edge or overweighting GWS home advantage.

- My adjustment: I weighted GWS home advantage at +7 to +8 pts (supported by venue data 66W-43L, +7.0 historical margin), which compresses the line to Brisbane by ~7-8 pts. This bridges the gap between the two markets and aligns with form + venue data. I reduced win probability from 68.8% to 62% to reflect this compression and my systematic recent underweighting of home ground advantage (62% of errors were away-team picks).

FATIGUE & TRAVEL IMPACT:

GWS Giants:

- Rest: 7 days (last game West Coast, 2026-05-17)

- Venue: Home (Sydney)

Round 11 | Docklands | 2026-05-24

Western Bulldogs vs Melbourne

MEDIUM CONFIDENCE

TIP: Western Bulldogs 61% win probability approx. 8pt margin

Western Bulldogs \$2.2 (45.5% implied) | Melbourne \$1.67 (59.8% implied) | Line: Melbourne Demons giving 6.5 pts

PREDICTED WINNER: Western Bulldogs

WIN PROBABILITY: Western Bulldogs: 61% | Melbourne: 39%

The Squiggle model (62.3% WBD) and recent form favour the Bulldogs, but this conflicts with the betting market (45.5% WBD implied). I weighted Squiggle at 50%, recent form trends at 30%, and the market at 20%. The market has been systematically underweighting home ground advantage in close matches this season, and my own calibration error (62% of errors were away-team picks) requires correction toward the home team here.

PREDICTED MARGIN: ~Western Bulldogs by 8 points

The Squiggle model predicts +18.7 pts for WBD. The line market implies Melbourne -6.5 pts. WBD's last-3 average margin is improving toward neutral (-7.4 pts over last 3, vs -32.6 over last 5), while Melbourne's margin has remained steady at +22.0 pts over last 5. At Docklands specifically, WBD averages +5.0 pts over the last 5 games and +4.8 pts historically (312 games), providing a +10 point home ground buffer over the line market's -6.5 pts implication.

KEY FACTORS:

- 1. Home ground advantage at Docklands is substantial and favours WBD: WBD holds a 53% win rate at Docklands historically (164W-148L) with an average margin of +4.8 pts, while Melbourne holds only 41% (31W-44L) with an average margin of -4.3 pts. WBD has 16 percentage points stronger home performance across the full multi-year dataset (54% home vs 38% away).
- 2. Melbourne's away record is significantly weaker than home: Melbourne's away win rate this season is 40% (2W-5L) compared to 100% at home (5W-5). The 60 percentage point gap indicates away venues materially degrade Melbourne's performance, and Docklands historically is a particularly poor venue for Melbourne.
- 3. WBD's attack is improving while defence is tightening: Over the last 3 games, WBD averaged 79.3 pts for (up from 70.8 over last 5) and 86.7 pts against (down from 103.4). This dual trend--scoring more, conceding less--directly contradicts their recent form. The last-3 average margin of -7.4 pts is substantially better than -32.6 over last 5, suggesting recovery from catastrophic losses to Sydney (-66 pts) and Geelong (-75 pts).
- 4. Injury toll favours Melbourne: WBD are without Tim English (All-Australian ruckman, concussion, unlikely Round 11) and Bailey Williams (midfielder, hamstring, high-grade, longer-term). Melbourne have no reported injuries. English's absence is particularly acute in a ruck contest against Melbourne, though WBD's recent improved defensive numbers suggest they have adapted.

SCORING TRENDS ANALYSIS:

Western Bulldogs (last 5): For 70.8 pts, Against 103.4 pts, Margin -32.6 pts. (last 3): For 79.3 pts, Against 86.7 pts, Margin -7.4 pts.

- Attack trend: Improving ^ (up 8.5 pts per game over 3 vs 5 games)
- Defence trend: Tightening v (16.7 pts conceded fewer per game over 3 vs 5 games)

Melbourne (last 5): For 112.6 pts, Against 90.6 pts, Margin +22.0 pts. (last 3): For 111.0 pts, Against 93.0 pts, Margin +18.0 pts.

- Attack trend: Stable (1.6 pts decline per game, marginal)
- Defence trend: Stable (slight deterioration: -2.4 pts conceded per game, marginal)

Advantage Analysis: Melbourne's absolute scoring output (111-112.6 pts) exceeds WBD's (70.8-79.3 pts) by 30+ pts. However, WBD's trajectory is sharply upward while Melbourne's is flat. WBD's defence has moved from catastrophically bad (103.4 conceded) to merely challenged (86.7 conceded), a swing of 16.7 pts--enough to materially shift the match outcome. Melbourne has shown no recent defensive decline, but also no improvement. At the point of this match, Melbourne retains a structural scoring advantage, but WBD's momentum is genuine and improving.

HOME GROUND ADVANTAGE:

Season win rates:

- Western Bulldogs: Home 2/4 (50%) | Away 3/6 (50%)
- Melbourne: Home 5/5 (100%) | Away 2/5 (40%)

Docklands-specific record (last 5 games):

- Western Bulldogs: 2W-3L, average margin +5.0 pts
- Melbourne: 2W-3L, average margin -0.2 pts

Historical Docklands record (312 games):

- Western Bulldogs: 164W-148L (53% win rate), average 97.4 pts for vs 92.6 against (margin +4.8 pts)
- Melbourne: 31W-44L (41% win rate), average 93.1 pts for vs 97.4 against (margin -4.3 pts)

Home ground advantage estimate: Standard AFL home ground advantage is valued at 8-15 pts. For this match, WBD's historical Docklands performance (+4.8 pts) combined with their multi-year home strength (+16 pp vs away) suggests a material but not massive advantage. Melbourne's poor historical Docklands record (41% win rate, -4.3 margin) reinforces this.

Estimating +10 points to WBD for home ground at this venue.

MARKET & MODEL ANALYSIS:

- H2H Market (implied): Western Bulldogs \$2.2 (45.5% implied) vs Melbourne \$1.67 (59.8% implied). Market favours Melbourne by ~14 percentage points.
- Line Market (implied): Melbourne giving 6.5 pts. This implies Melbourne expected margin of +6.5, equivalent to a ~54% win probability under standard conversion.
- Squiggle Model: Western Bulldogs 62.3% win probability, +18.7 pts margin.

Agreement/Disagreement:

- Squiggle disagrees strongly with the betting market. Squiggle tips WBD by 62.3%, market implies Melbourne 59.8%.
- The line market (Melbourne -6.5) is closer to the market's H2H odds than to Squiggle but still sits between the two signals.

Weighting Decision: I have weighted Squiggle at 50% here, market at 20%, and form trends at 30%. Rationale: (1) Squiggle has access to team rating data not visible in this summary; (2) the betting market has embedded an overround (~10%) and my own accuracy history shows I have systematically underweighted home ground advantage, meaning the market's away-team bias aligns with my documented error pattern; (3) WBD's recent form improvement (last 3 vs last 5) is a legitimate signal the market may have lagged, as the market prices are typically set days before round data settles.

FATIGUE & TRAVEL IMPACT:

- Western Bulldogs: 8 days rest. Playing at home in Melbourne (no travel).
- Melbourne: 8 days rest. Playing away (listed as "home in Melbourne" in the data, but this is a neutral venue--both teams are based in Melbourne). No travel fatigue.

Impact: Both teams have identical rest. Both are playing in their home city at a neutral venue (Docklands). Fatigue is not a real differentiator in this match.

WEATHER IMPACT:

Marvel Stadium has a roof. Weather conditions will not affect play. Neutral.

TEAM NEWS IMPACT:

Western Bulldogs -- OUT:

- Tim English (All-Australian ruckman): Concussion,